

# Consultation Paper - Proposed Rosters for Switchboard Services, Logan Hospital

## 1. Purpose

The purpose of this document is to reinvigorate the consultation process for a proposed roster for Switchboard Services, Logan Hospital, Corporate Services, Logan and Beaudesert Health Service (LBHS), Metro South Health (MSH).

## 2. Background

On 22 July 2021, Metro South Health (MSH) management, affected staff and Together Queensland representatives commenced negotiating a new roster for Switchboard Services, Logan Hospital.

Over the course of these negotiations, valuable feedback from staff and Together Queensland has been considered and included in numerous draft rosters.

In August 2024, Switchboard Services, Logan Hospital was realigned from Health Information Management Services (HIMS), MSH to Corporate Services, LBHS, MSH.

## 3. Proposed change

Based on the comprehensive feedback to date and acknowledging the passage of time since roster negotiations commenced; LBHS management have developed a new proposed roster (**Attachment 1**) to reinvigorate the consultation process.

The proposed roster is intended to introduce a more equitable roster for Switchboard Services, Logan Hospital staff and includes:

- Redistribution of nights for greater equity based on FTE.
- Rotational roster for predictability and equity to all staff ensuring fair distribution of penalties.
- Extension of the current weekday (Mon-Fri) 0900-1400 five (5) hour shift to a 0700-1500 eight (8) hour shift.
- An additional eight (8) hour shift (1200-2000) on weekdays.
- An additional eight (8) hour shift (0700-1500) on Saturdays, to assist with call volume.
- An additional eight (8) hour shift (0600-1400) on certain days in the roster to provide for Switchboard administration, upskilling employees to provide them with a wider skill base, and more professional development opportunities.

The proposed roster will be trialled for a period of 6 months. At the conclusion of 6 months a review will be undertaken to evaluate the effectiveness.

To support effective operations of rostering and staffing for Switchboard Services, Logan Hospital; rostering principles and information forms part of **Attachment 2**.



#### 4. Ballot and feedback

In accordance with Clause 6.2 of the [Hospital and Health Service General Employees \(Queensland Health\) Award – State 2015](#), agreement between MSH and the union, or MSH and the majority of employees affected must occur.

Agreement is defined as obtaining consent from the majority (50+1%) of affected employees, with employees invited to cast their vote and/or provide feedback via [clicking on this link](#) or scanning this QR Code:



#### 5. Support for affected employees

LBHS is committed to the health, safety, and wellbeing of all our employees and acknowledges change may be a difficult time for affected employees. The following support mechanisms are offered to staff during this time:

- Employees may access the Employee Assistance Program by telephoning TELUS Health on 1800 604 640 and accessing information at <http://qheps.health.qld.gov.au/eap/>.
- Availability of unit management
- If an employee is a member of a Union, please contact your Union Organiser or Delegate who can also provide industrial relations and other guidance and support at this time.

#### 6. Union Contacts

| Contact/ Title           | Name          | Email                                                                                                                                                  | Phone Number |
|--------------------------|---------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|
| Together Queensland (TQ) | James Douglas | <a href="mailto:james.douglas@together.org.au">james.douglas@together.org.au</a><br><a href="mailto:health@together.org.au">health@together.org.au</a> |              |

#### 7. Proposal on endorsement (after consultation)

Should the proposed roster (**Attachment 1**) be agreed between MSH and the Together Queensland, or MSH and the majority (50+1%) of affected employees, it is proposed the roster be trialled for 6 months, after which an evaluation will be undertaken to review the effectiveness.

In the event agreement is not reached, LBHS commits to working with affected employees and Together Queensland to amicably resolve concerns with a view to reach agreement, prior to the proposed implementation date.

#### 8. Dates

| Date             | Activity                          |
|------------------|-----------------------------------|
| 12 November 2024 | Consultation period opens         |
| 8 December 2024  | Consultation period closes        |
| 16 December 2024 | Feedback considered and addressed |
| 20 January 2025  | Proposed roster implemented       |

9. Approval

| Name                                                                                         |  | Approval  |                                                                                    |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--|-----------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Approved to commence consultation:                                                           |  | Signature |  |
| <b>Scott Hughes</b><br>Director<br>Corporate Services<br>Logan and Beaudesert Health Service |  | Date      | 12 / 11 / 2024                                                                     |



| Name                             | Week Three |           |           |           |           |           |           | Week Four |           |           |           |           |           |           |
|----------------------------------|------------|-----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|-----------|
|                                  | Monday     | Tuesday   | Wednesday | Thursday  | Friday    | Saturday  | Sunday    | Monday    | Tuesday   | Wednesday | Thursday  | Friday    | Saturday  | Sunday    |
|                                  | 0700-0900  | 0900-1100 | 1100-1300 | 1300-1500 | 1500-1700 | 1700-1900 | 1900-2100 | 0700-0900 | 0900-1100 | 1100-1300 | 1300-1500 | 1500-1700 | 1700-1900 | 1900-2100 |
| A Existing Perm Appointment      |            |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |
| B Existing Perm Appointment      |            |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |
| C Existing Perm Appointment      |            |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |
| D Existing Perm Appointment      |            |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |
| E Existing Perm Appointment      |            |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |
| F Existing Perm Appointment      |            |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |
| G Existing Perm Appointment      |            |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |
| Part Time 0.8 FTE, 64 hr         |            |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |
| A Existing Perm Appointment      |            |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |
| Part Time 0.7 FTE, 56 hr         |            |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |
| A Existing Perm Appointment      |            |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |
| B Existing Perm Appointment      |            |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |
| Part Time 0.7 FTE (New)          |            |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |
| A Perm Appointment (extra night) |            |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |
| Part Time 0.5 FTE (New)          |            |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |
| A Perm Appointment (extra night) |            |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |
| Part Time 0.6 FTE                |            |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |
| A Existing Perm Appointment      |            |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |
| Part Time 0.5 FTE                |            |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |
| A Existing Perm Appointment      |            |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |
|                                  |            |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |           |

## Attachment 2: Switchboard Services, Logan Hospital Rostering Principles and Information

### **ROSTER PRINCIPLES**

- **Shift Swaps:**

Switchboard staff are to provide three working days' written notice and AVAC is to be completed for shift swap requests by staff members and sent to Switchboard Manager for approval. All shift swaps for weekends must be made to management for consideration by the Wednesday prior and management agree to review within 48 hours with written response to requestor. If shift swap requested is not approved, then staff are required to work their original rostered shift.

- An AVAC is to be completed when adjustments need to be made to a rostered shift e.g., Shift swaps.
  - Please ensure all fields are completed and information is correct.
  - For assistance in completing an AVAC please consult the Switchboard Manager.

- **Sick / Emergent Leave:**

To ensure shift coverage can be found it is requested as much notice as possible be given if calling in for sick or emergent leave, particularly for night shifts and early morning shifts, however a minimum of two hours' notice is required unless extraordinary circumstances prevent appropriate notice from being given.

During Business Hours M-F, Switchboard staff are to call through to the Switchboard and ask to be referred/transferred through to the Switchboard Manager, who will take the call and provide coverage for the shift.

After-hours, Switchboard staff are to call through to the Switchboard Oncall for any sick/emergent leave. The Switchboard staff who take the call are then responsible for organising coverage and need to follow the below process. Sick/emergent leave will first be offered to any permanent/temp part-time staff members. If the shift needing to be filled is not congruent with other part time shifts, then the shift will be offered to casual staff. If in the event that a casual is also unavailable, available full-time staff will then be offered overtime, approval from the Switchboard Oncall must be sought prior to a full-time staff member being offered overtime. Once the shift has been covered, a detailed email from the Logan Switch account will need to send to the Switchboard Manager/Oncall outlining who has been called, at what time the call was made who declined/accepted the shift.

- On the days where there is an additional 06:00-14:00 or 07:00-15:00 shift that requires covering of emergent leave, coverage of these shifts is at the discretion of the Switchboard Manager based on operational need. Therefore, contact must first be made with the Switchboard Manager to see if coverage for the shift is necessary.
- When there is a duplicate 06:00-14:00 shift (apricot in colour on the roster) depending on staffing levels in Switchboard and call volume at the time, this shift can be used for switchboard operation and/or for switchboard administration and to up-skill staff, training and provide professional development for switchboard staff.

Below process is to be followed by Switchboard afterhours for sick/emergent leave:

**To be offered following below order**

- Permanent part-time staff – always least amount of shifts gets asked first (up to 9 shifts)
- Temporary part-time staff – always least amount of shifts gets asked first (up to 9 shifts)
- Casual staff – always least amount of shifts gets asked first (up to 9 shifts)

Permanent and Temporary Full-time staff – last option and needs prior approval from Switchboard Manager.

- If there is no one available to work the full shift and need to split shift this also needs to be prior approved by the Switchboard Manager/Oncall
- All emergent leave and sick leave, please email Switchboard Manager/Oncall with shift changes and who has been called, what time the call was made, who declined/accepted shifts. Email needs to be sent from Logan switch account.
- Afterhours coverage needs to be prior approved by Switchboard Manager/Oncall if resulting in overtime. Email follows with shift changes and who has been called, what time the call was made, who declined/accepted shifts. Email needs to be sent from Logan switch account.

### **Meal Breaks**

To ensure Switchboard is manned to an optimal level, it is important to adhere to the scheduled break times as listed below. If for any reason staff are unable to observe these times during a shift, please consult Switchboard Manager, noting the requirement that meal breaks are taken between the third and sixth hours of duty in accordance with section 16 of the Award and rest breaks are to be taken during the first and second half of the working day in accordance with section 17 of the Award. Should staff be requested to work additional hours they are advised to check with Switchboard Manager if they are eligible for a supplementary break. This is dependent on the number of additional hours worked. Noting the relevant section of the Award is section 13.7(c) of the Award as this details when an additional break becomes an entitlement and that is every four hours of continuous overtime.

| Shift Start   | 1 <sup>st</sup> Break | 2 <sup>nd</sup> Break | 3 <sup>rd</sup> Break |
|---------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|
| 06:00-14:00 A | 0800<br>10 mins       | 10:30<br>30 mins      | 13:00<br>10 mins      |
| 06:00-14:00 B | 08:10<br>10 mins      | 11:00<br>30 mins      | 13:10<br>10 mins      |
| 07:00-15:00 A | 9:00<br>10 mins       | 11:30<br>30 mins      | 14:00<br>10 mins      |
| 07:00-15:00 B | 9:10<br>10 mins       | 12:00<br>30 mins      | 14:10<br>10 mins      |
| 12:00-20:00   | 14:00<br>10 mins      | 17:00<br>30 mins      | 19:00<br>10 mins      |
| 14:00-22:00   | 16:00<br>10 mins      | 18:30<br>30 mins      | 21:00<br>10 mins      |
| 15:00-23:00   | 17:00<br>10 mins      | 19:30<br>30 mins      | 22:00<br>10 mins      |
| 22:00-06:00   | 12:00<br>10 mins      | 02:30<br>30 mins      | 05:00<br>10 mins      |
| 23:00-07:00   | 01:00<br>10 mins      | 03:30<br>30 mins      | 06:00<br>10 mins      |

### **ROSTER INFORMATION**

- Penalties have been allocated based on FTE to ensure fair and equitable distribution of penalty shifts across the whole roster.
- In this roster nights are allocated based on proportion of FTE so to be fair and equitable to all Switchboard staff as far as possible and to maximise health safety and wellbeing, work-life balance and to minimise staff fatigue. Noting there is one exception to this rule and there are two new roster lines for a 0.7 FTE and 0.5 FTE which do have extra night shifts rostered (to reduce the number of nights our full-time and part-time staff need to work, providing a more equitable balance)
- This roster is a rotational and cyclic roster. Thus, staff work a line relevant to their FTE, e.g., weeks 1-4 and then they drop down to the line below and work their way through the various lines and back to the top again and repeat. For our part-time lines where there is only one line staff rotate through weeks 1-4 and then back to beginning of the roster pattern in week 1.

- Allocation of lines: Roster lines will be allocated based on payroll number.
- This roster will be trialled for duration of one whole rotation of the fulltime lines, for 6 months. Where we will then review and seek further feedback from staff. However, should there be any significant issues or faults identified in the roster during this trial these will be reviewed as they occur.
- Once implemented this roster will be projected forward for 12 months for staff advanced knowledge of the shifts.
- This roster has been created using principles from the 'Metro South Best Practice Rostering Guideline', which includes designing to mitigate a roster to try and mitigate fatigue, to promote fairness, equity and work-life balance whilst still meeting organisational staffing and service needs.
- Due to call volumes, there will be no reduction in workforce on Public Holidays.